

EE/RPF

For use from May/November 2027

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International Baccalaureate®
Baccalauréat International
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Student personal code:

Extended essay - Reflection and progress form

Student: This form is to be completed by you and your supervisor during the progress and completion of the extended essay. It records your progress through the extended essay process and includes your reflective statement addressing your extended essay experience. You must undertake three formal reflection sessions with your supervisor: The first formal reflection session should focus on your initial ideas and how you plan to undertake your research; the interim reflection session takes place once a significant amount of your research has been completed, and the final session will be in the form of a viva voce, once you have completed and handed in your extended essay. This document acts as a record in supporting the authenticity of your work. Following the viva voce, you write a **reflective statement** of no more than 500 words., which must be included on the RPF.

The completion of this form is a mandatory requirement of the extended essay. It must be submitted together with the completed essay. The reflective statement will then be assessed under Criterion E. Students and supervisors should be aware that a mark of 0 will be awarded by the examiner for criterion E if the RPF is blank or the reflective statement is written in a language other than that of the accompanying essay.

Supervisor: You must have three reflection sessions with each student, one early in the process, an interim meeting and then the final viva voce. Other check-in sessions are permitted but do not need to be recorded on this sheet. After each reflection session you must record the month that the reflection session took place, the student's year of DP study at that time and initial the form.

By submitting this student work for assessment, you are taking responsibility for its authenticity. No piece of student work should be uploaded/submitted to the e-Coursework system if its authenticity is in doubt.

First reflection session

Month: DP year (1 or 2): Supervisor initials:

Interim reflection session

Month: DP year (1 or 2): Supervisor initials:

Final reflection session – Viva voce

Month: DP year (1 or 2): Supervisor initials:

Reflective statement

(No more than 500 words, written in the same language as the accompanying extended essay)

The decision to write a World Studies Essay arose from dissatisfaction with a single subject approach. Early drafts which explored communication through either an exclusively English or an anthropological perspective lacked the breadth to develop true insights into what impacts the success of interpersonal communication. When I wrote an English draft, I felt forced to assume that the audience would have a true understanding of the norms and conventions used to 'properly' understand meaning. Likewise, an anthropological draft lacked a focus on how media conventions are used to communicate, which made it equally unsuitable in allowing me to truly understand how Pingu was able to communicate nonverbally across cultures.

Having decided on a World Studies Essay, new difficulties arose. While both subjects appear similar and are part of the humanities, there are substantial differences in methodology. I therefore adjusted my research question to better focus on their common ground: how meaning is communicated across cultures through nonverbal communication in media. This focus on media allowed me to understand the role that conventions play in communication and how culture can impact these conventions across different societies.

My decision to include English in my World Studies Essay has proved immensely beneficial. I had always struggled with the task of analysing texts, especially in comparison to my stronger understanding of how similar level concepts are analysed in maths and sciences. It is the inherent level of subjectivity in humanities subjects which has plagued me since 11th grade history courses. There are no comforting equations or experiments as in the sciences and maths. However, the Essay has helped me to improve my subjective analytical skills, resulting in improved English grades. I feel unbelievably proud for having improved to the point where I feel somewhat confident in my ability to understand the inner machinations of any text I read.